Skill Builder Pack 4D — The IF Function

We are now working from **SKILL 4D - IF** and we will add **new columns** to create decisions.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1	student_name	Attendance Status	Delivery Mode	Engagement Score Weekly	Engagement Risk Band	Risk Check	Absence Con	Absent AND High Risk	
2	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High				
3	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High				
4	David Wilson	Present	On Campus	68	Medium				
5	Sarah Smith	Present	On Campus	82	Low				
6	James Taylor	Authorised Absence	On Campus	83	Low				
7	Lily Brown	Present	Remote	84	Low				
8	Emily Clark	Absent	On Campus	91	Low				
9	Daniel Green	Present	Hybrid	92	Low				
10	Sophia White	Present	Hybrid	65	Medium				
11	Lucas Hall	Present	Remote	76	Low				
12	Olivia King	Late	Remote	82	Low				
13	Henry Scott	Present	On Campus	83	Low				
14	Ava Turner	Present	On Campus	66	Medium				
15	Jack Hill	Present	Remote	63	Medium				
16	Mia Adams	Present	On Campus	86	Low				
17	Noah Baker	Present	Remote	82	Low				
18	Grace Nelson	Present	On Campus	93	Low				
19	Leo Carter	Present	On Campus	76	Low				
20	Ella Mitchell	Present	Remote	77	Low				
21	Oscar Perez	Present	Remote	56	High				
22	Isla Roberts	Present	Hybrid	84	Low				
23	Amelia Walker	Authorised Absence	On Campus	85	Low				
24	Ethan Phillips	Present	Hybrid	76	Low				
25	Freya Campbell	Present	Remote	69	Medium				
26	Benjamin Parker	Present	Remote	88	Low				
27	Chloe Evans	Present	On Campus	94	Low				
28	Arthur Edwards	Present	Hybrid	77	Low				
29	Sienna Collins	Present	Remote	78	Low				
30	Thomas Stewart	Present	Remote	79	Low				
31	Evie Morris	Absent	Hybrid	70	Medium				
32									

Key Idea

We are now answering:

> "If something is true, what should happen?"

Excel will:

- look at one row
- check a rule
- return one result if true
- return another if false

SECTION 1 — Understanding IF

Structure:

=IF(condition, value_if_true, value_if_false)

What this means:

1. IF this is true → do this
2. Otherwise → do this

SECTION 2 — Simple IF (one condition)

Question 1

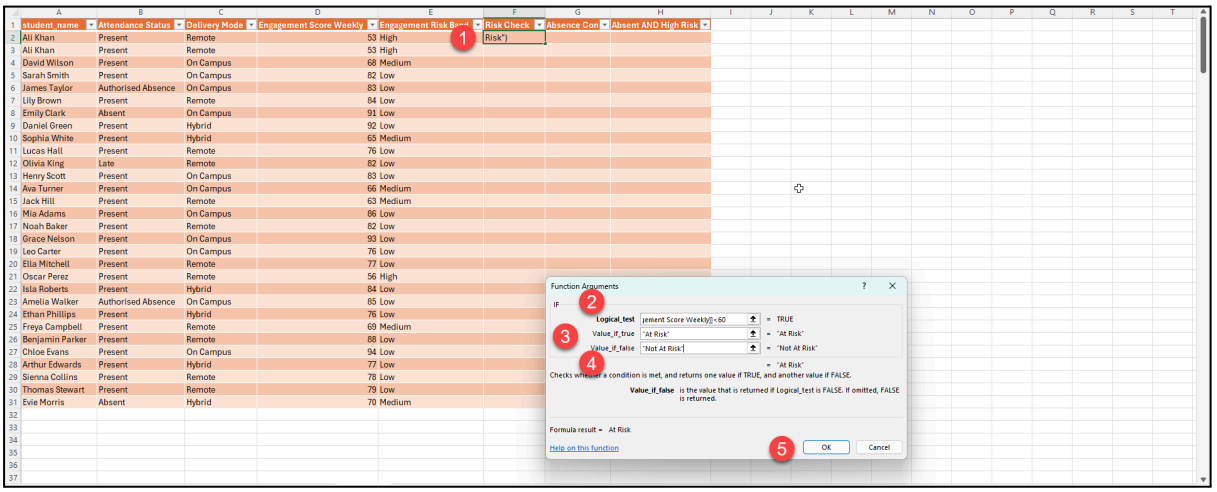
Is the student **At Risk** based on score?

Rule:

- If score is less than 60 → "At Risk"
- Otherwise → "Not At Risk"

What you do:

1. Select column F2, press fx and search for IF - click on OK to open the Wizard
2. For Logical_test, select cell D2 < 60 (it will appear as [@[Engagement Score Weekly]]<60)
3. For Value_if_true, type in At Risk
4. ForValue_if_false, type in Not At Risk
5. Click on OK



This will populate the column with the outputs we specify.

student_name	Attendance Status	Delivery Mode	Engagement Score Weekly	Engagement Risk Band	Risk Check	Absence Con	Absent AND High Risk
Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	At Risk		
Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	At Risk		
David Wilson	Present	On Campus	68	Medium	Not At Risk		
Sarah Smith	Present	On Campus	82	Low	Not At Risk		
James Taylor	Authorised Absence	On Campus	83	Low	Not At Risk		
Lily Brown	Present	Remote	84	Low	Not At Risk		
Emily Clark	Absent	On Campus	91	Low	Not At Risk		
Daniel Green	Present	Hybrid	92	Low	Not At Risk		
Sophia White	Present	Hybrid	65	Medium	Not At Risk		
Lucas Hall	Present	Remote	76	Low	Not At Risk		
Olivia King	Late	Remote	82	Low	Not At Risk		
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Ava Turner	Present	On Campus	66	Medium	Not At Risk		
Jack Hill	Present	Remote	63	Medium	Not At Risk		
Mia Adams	Present	On Campus	86	Low	Not At Risk		
Noah Baker	Present	Remote	82	Low	Not At Risk		
Grace Nelson	Present	On Campus	93	Low	Not At Risk		
Leo Carter	Present	On Campus	76	Low	Not At Risk		
Ella Mitchell	Present	Remote	77	Low	Not At Risk		
Oscar Perez	Present	Remote	56	High	At Risk		
Isla Roberts	Present	Hybrid	84	Low	Not At Risk		
Amelia Walker	Authorised Absence	On Campus	85	Low	Not At Risk		
Ethan Phillips	Present	Hybrid	76	Low	Not At Risk		
Freya Campbell	Present	Remote	69	Medium	Not At Risk		
Benjamin Parker	Present	Remote	88	Low	Not At Risk		
Chloe Evans	Present	On Campus	94	Low	Not At Risk		
Arthur Edwards	Present	Hybrid	77	Low	Not At Risk		
Sienna Collins	Present	Remote	78	Low	Not At Risk		
Thomas Stewart	Present	Remote	79	Low	Not At Risk		
Evie Morris	Absent	Hybrid	70	Medium	Not At Risk		

What Excel is doing:

For each row:

1. Look at the score
2. Ask: “Is this less than 60?”

If YES → write “At Risk”

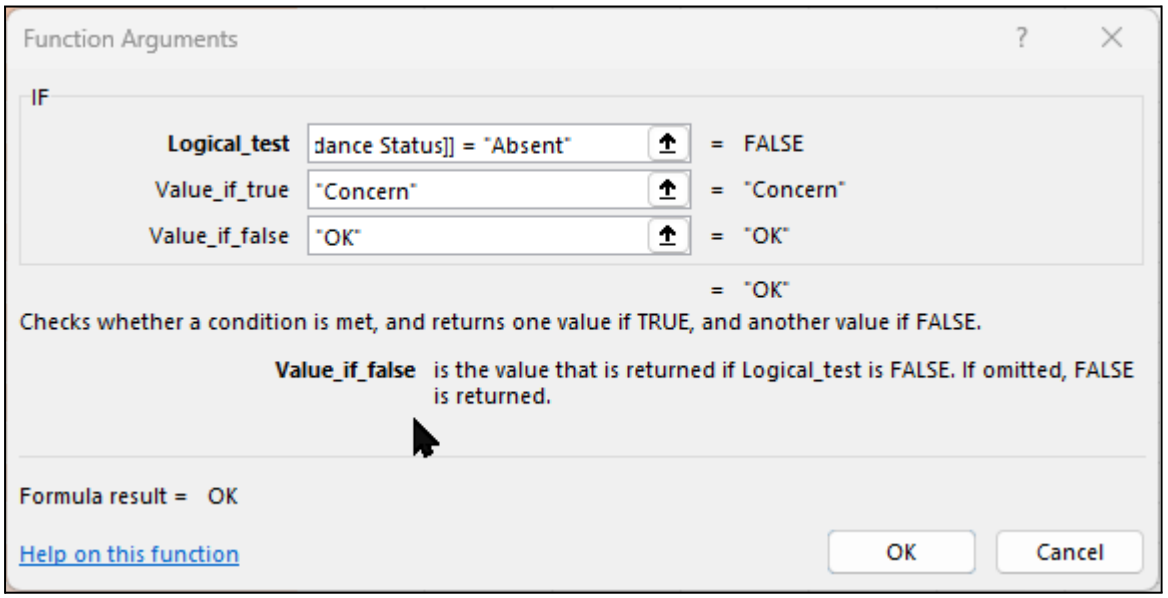
If NO → write “Not At Risk”

SECTION 3 — IF with text (checking words)

Question 2

Flag students who were **Absent**

What you do:



What Excel is doing:

1. Excel looks at Attendance Status
2. It checks: “Does this say Absent?”

If YES → “Concern”
If NO → “OK”

SECTION 4 — Combining conditions (AND)

Key Idea

Sometimes we want:

> “this AND this”

Question 3

Flag students who are **Absent AND High Risk**

What you do:

=IF(AND(B2="Absent", E2="High"),"High Concern","OK")

What Excel is doing:

For each row:

1. Is Attendance = Absent?
2. AND is Risk = High?

Both must be true

If YES → “High Concern”
If NO → “OK”

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
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2	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	At Risk	OK	Ok
3	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	At Risk	OK	Ok
4	David Wilson	Present	On Campus	68	Medium	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
5	Sarah Smith	Present	On Campus	82	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
6	James Taylor	Authorised Absence	On Campus	83	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
7	Lily Brown	Present	Remote	84	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
8	Emily Clark	Absent	On Campus	91	Low	Not At Risk	Concern	Ok
9	Daniel Green	Present	Hybrid	92	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
10	Sophia White	Present	Hybrid	65	Medium	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
11	Lucas Hall	Present	Remote	76	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
12	Olivia King	Late	Remote	82	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
13	Henry Scott	Present	On Campus	83	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
14	Ava Turner	Present	On Campus	66	Medium	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
15	Jack Hill	Present	Remote	63	Medium	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
16	Mia Adams	Present	On Campus	86	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
17	Noah Baker	Present	Remote	82	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
18	Grace Nelson	Present	On Campus	93	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
19	Leo Carter	Present	On Campus	76	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
20	Ella Mitchell	Present	Remote	77	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
21	Oscar Perez	Present	Remote	56	High	At Risk	OK	Ok
22	Isla Roberts	Present	Hybrid	84	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
23	Amelia Walker	Authorised Absence	On Campus	85	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
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27	Chloe Evans	Present	On Campus	94	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
28	Arthur Edwards	Present	Hybrid	77	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
29	Sienna Collins	Present	Remote	78	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
30	Thomas Stewart	Present	Remote	79	Low	Not At Risk	OK	Ok
31	Evie Morris	Absent	Hybrid	70	Medium	Not At Risk	Concern	Ok
32								

SECTION 5 — Important mindset

What Excel is doing every time:

- It looks at one row
- It checks your rule
- It decides: true or false
- It returns a result

Keep it simple:

IF = decision

The simplest way to remember:

> IF = “If this is true, do this. Otherwise do this.”

Final note

If you get stuck:

> “Excel is just checking the row and making a yes/no decision”